

Motorola's update

Motorola has confirmed to launch Droid 2 with Android 2.2 OS

HTML 5 for mobile

AOL has rolled out HTML5 mobile site which is specially designed for cellphones And 2 new Android apps

2GB DDR3 1066MHz RAM, LED backlit LCD screen, a 64 GB SSD, USB 2.0 interface, a 1MP web cam, 729MB shared video RAM for the Intel HD integrated graphics solution, and a 1.2 GHz Pentium U5400 processor with 3MB L3 cache.

Possibly the best part about the device is the way Toshiba has managed to split Windows 7 OS across two displays vertically, giving users excellent video real estate, while ensuring a large sized onscreen keyboard which ranges from 3-line, 4-line, and split-QWERTY configurations, to a number pad. The dedicated keyboard button, is accompanied by a home and power/sleep button. The accelerometer works well to switch from laptop mode to book mode, and, you can drag and drop content from one screen to the other.

Unfortunately, the W100 device has some drawbacks right from the get-go, namely, its 4 hour battery backup, and a mono-speaker which when we tested it, was not very powerful. We however have great hopes for the device, though at its price point, it will not become common as the iPad or netbook.

Qosmio F60

The Toshiba Qosmio F60-X5310 is an extraordinary 15.6-inch entertainment laptop that has some very powerful features, namely the Toshiba Quad-core graphics processor (you know, the one the PlayStation 3 has, the famous Cell processor?) that uses a Spurs Engine, a Core i5 processor, and integrated Harman Kardon stereo speakers. This Cell GPU is the primary difference between this model and the one released in Europe in January, which featured an

Nvidia 330M GPU instead.

Starting at Rs. 61,490, the Qosmio F60-X5310 15.6-inch screen is LED backlit and has a wide 16:9 aspect ratio, at a native resolution of 1366x768 pixels. Users will greatly enjoy the benefits of the quad-core Cell processor GPU, especially in hardware video encoding. An example of this is Toshiba's Upconversion Technology called Resolution+ (also seen in the Portégé R700), which uses a proprietary super-resolution algorithm solution to up convert standard definition images/videos to near high



Libretto W100

definition level. Another great multimedia feature is one of the three Toshiba Value-Add software available on the laptop, namely Toshiba Face Navigation, which lets users select any face in a video, after which they can see all the parts of the video where the face appears. Useful if you are looking for a particular part of a movie.

However, what is perhaps the most exciting thing about the laptop is the Toshiba Gesture Controller, which using the laptop's integrated 1.3MP HD Automacro Webcam and the Quad-Core GPU to simultaneously recognise and interpret a user's hand gestures. This allows the user to control media as well as the mouse pointer with simple hand gestures.

AC100 smart companion

The 10-inch Android-based and Tegra 2 powered AC100 smart companion offers a smooth transition across the difference in visual real estate from a phone to a tablet/clamshell (just like iPad does for the iPhone); giving Android smartphone users the opportunity to bridge the gap. The AC100 smart companion and an Android smartphone crucially differ in one regard, the presence of a hardware keyboard. Android 2.1 as a framework is built for a multitouch interface, along with four dedicated buttons. By choosing to go in for the laptop form factor, engineers at Toshiba challenged themselves to modify the Android OS to conform to a keyboard, and in the process, have heavily customised it.

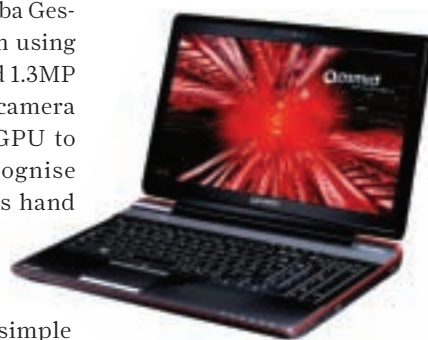
The Toshiba AC100 will also be one of the Tegra 2 first devices to hit the market, and the world will look on to see if the SoC can perform to its potential. This also gives the AC100 a one-of-a-kind status of being the only 3G capable-Google Android-NVIDIA Tegra-laptop around, and makes it much more powerful than its (albeit tablet but) counterpart device, the iPad, in almost all departments. It features a 10.1-inch LED backlit screen, 8GB NAND

flash memory, 512MB RAM, 1.3 megapixel camera, Bluetooth 2.1, full 1080p video, SD card reader, USB & HDMI port, 802.11 b/g/n Wi-Fi, and a full size keyboard.

The AC100 smart companion will operate in always-on mode just like the iPad, but offers a slightly lesser 8 hours of mixed browsing-video playback battery life, with a seven day standby time. Users will have access to a variety of applications and widgets from a separate source (for now) than the Android Marketplace, apart from the many pre-installed applications such as Opera Mobile, Facebook, Twitter, YouTube, Fring, an Office document editor, an email client, and the Toshiba Media Player. Users will also be able to set up to five homescreens that can also be made to change with work and life profiles, and GPS positioning. The Opera Mobile browser has probably been chosen over the Android WebKit-browser simply to avoid touch issues.

Calling it "building from the ground up", Toshiba's decision to devise a hardware keyboard solution for the Android platform is certainly still puzzling, perhaps more so, that they have chosen to do away with the touchscreen completely. This, after they showed off their touch engineering ability with the dual-touchscreen mini-Win7-notebook, the Libretto.

The Toshiba AC100 smart companion will release in Q3 of this year, starting with Europe, Middle East, and Africa. An Android 2.2 update will be available shortly as well, which will give it full Flash 10.1 support. 



Qosmio F60